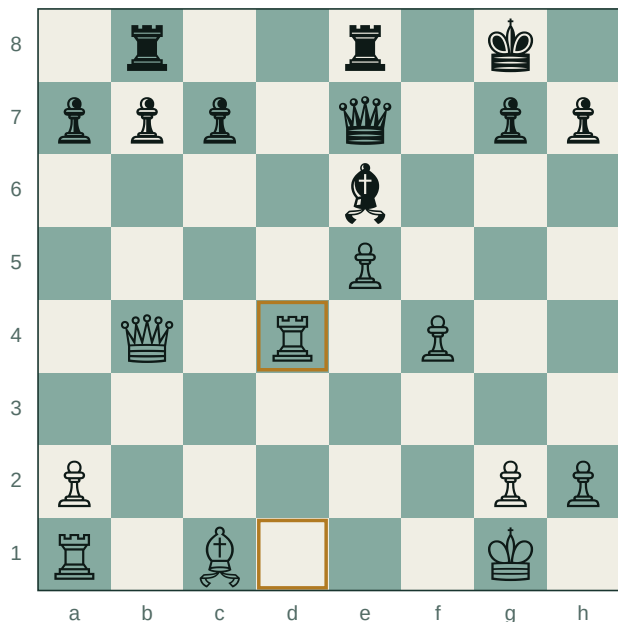


Forks and double attacks: Black, move 19

Forks and double attacks

Black to move



Previous move: 19.Rxd4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

19...c5 20. Qa3 cxd4 21. Qxe7 Rxe7

19...c5 The pawn moves from c7 to c5. From c5 it attacks queen on b4 and rook on d4. Recorded reply: **20.Qa3**.

20...cxd4 The pawn captures the rook on d4. The changed line means the queen on e7 attacks the queen on a3. Recorded reply: **21.Qxe7**.

21...Rxe7 The rook captures the queen on e7.

At the end, nominal material is White 13 / Black 18 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from +0 to +5. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Two attacked pieces do not guarantee a gain if the forking piece can be captured or one target moves with check.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A fork attacks multiple targets at once. The combination works when the defender cannot save everything or generate a stronger forcing reply.

HOW TO LOOK

Look for checking forks first, then double attacks on queens, rooks, and undefended pieces. Follow the line until the material is actually collected.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: rook on a1. Check for tactical protection.